PART VIII · PLAYING AND LISTENING · 4

Listening

Your ear is a musical instrument too. Train it in small steps: clap a rhythm back, sing a tune back, then hear whether music goes up or down, is major or minor, and whether it has finished.

THE SECRET

Sing it back first: if you can sing it, you can play it.



Questions for your ear

Major or minor?



C E G, then C E♭ G: bright, then darker.

Only the middle note changes. Major usually sounds bright and open, minor darker or sadder. Sing the middle note of each and hear it drop.

Intervals by song

INTERVAL	THE FIRST TWO NOTES OF…
major 2nd	Frère Jacques (Frè-re)
major 3rd	Oh When the Saints (Oh when)
perfect 4th	Amazing Grace (A-ma)
perfect 5th	Twinkle (twin-kle **TWIN**: the 2nd to the 3rd note)
major 6th	My Bonnie (My Bon-)
octave	Somewhere over the Rainbow (Some-where)

HOW TO

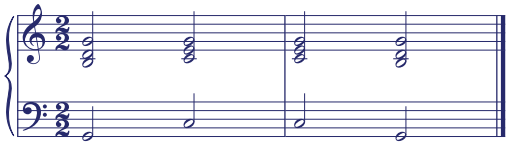
Clap it back

1. **Someone claps** a rhythm of two bars.
2. **You clap it back** straight away, keeping the beat.
3. **Then sing back** a short tune, then find it on the keys.

PART VIII · PLAYING AND LISTENING · 4 · CONTINUED

EXAMPLE 1

Finished or not?



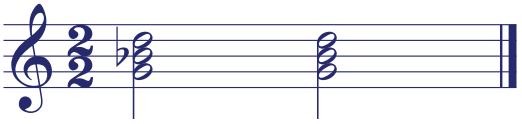
?

1 **Bar 1** ends on which chord? 2 **Bar 2** ends on which chord? 3 **Which ending** sounds finished?

Bar 1 ends **home** on C (a perfect cadence: finished); bar 2 stops on G (imperfect: not finished).

EXAMPLE 2

Major or minor?



?

1 **Play the first chord.** Bright or dark? 2 **The second?** 3 **Which note** changed?

First **minor**, then **major**: only the middle note moved, B♭ up to B.

GAME

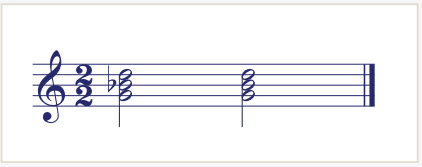
Which song?

1	2	3
5th up	octave up	4th up

Name a song with that leap near the start.

Answer: 1 Twinkle · 2 Somewhere over the Rainbow · 3 Amazing Grace.

TRY IT · 10 SECONDS



Bright or dark?

Ask someone to play major or minor chords in any order. Say “bright” or “dark” for each. Ten in a row?

TRAP

× Guessing from the hands: close your eyes and listen.

SEE ALSO

Intervals p. 42 · Cadences p. 136

PRACTISE IT

Online: Ear trainer